
Building China Presence
for Company Open
Prepared by Impact Science


Agenda
1 Background and Scope of the Project
2 Key Findings from Discovery Session
3 Perceived obstacles identified
4 Competitive landscape analysis
5 Solution creation for Company Open


1
Background and Scope of the Project


Background and Scope of the Project


Premise


2
Key Findings From Discovery Session


Key Findings from Discovery Session (1/2)
Core goal
Core TG
Active Authors
Published Authors
Readers


Key Findings from Discovery Sessions (2/2)
Enablers
Offline activities
Online
Value propositions of Company Open


3
Perceived obstacles identified


Perceived Challenges
Strong Competitors
ELSEVIER
SPRINGER NATURE
Taylor & Francis
AAAS
WILEY
IOPscience
Company Open perception in China
Email marketing


4
Competitive landscape analysis


Competitor Research

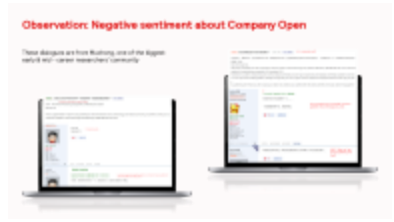



SPRINGER NATURE


WILEY




Learnings from Competitors


Observation: Negative sentiment about Company Open


Observation: Negative sentiment about Company Open


5
Solution creation for Company Open


Phase wise plan
Initiation
Expansion
Segmented Outreach


Phase 1: Initiation (0-6 months)


Phase 2: Expansion (6-12 months)


Phase 3: (12 month onwards)
Optimize & Grow


Way Forward


Thank you



Building China Presence for Company Open

Prepared by Impact Science

July 2025

Agenda



1. Background and Scope of the Project
2. Key Findings from Discovery Session
3. Perceived obstacles identified
4. Competitive landscape analysis
5. Solution creation for Company Open



1

Background and Scope of the Project

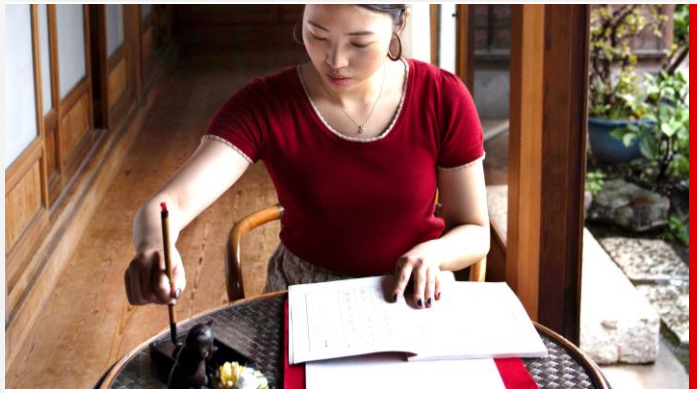
Key Findings from Discovery Session

Perceived obstacles identified

Competitive landscape analysis

Solution creation for Company Open

Background and Scope of the Project



Expansion to China is a key strategic step to capture market & facilitate growth

Company Open is world's first Open Access Book publisher with 3 major focus areas-

- Physical Sciences, engineering & technology
- Life sciences & health sciences
- Social sciences & humanities



Scope for this project

Short Term Goals

- Understand the cultural nuances of the dynamic China market to attract and acquire researchers (for readership), authors and editors (for publishing).
  (These two groups can be and in some cases are mutually inclusive)
- Align marketing and branding strategy to China Market

Long-term goals

Ensure steady growth in publications & chapters from China segment

End Goal

To Widen Communication channels and improve Company Open rankings in China segment.

Premise

Company Open has been taken some China-specific initiatives including-

- Offline events & communication
- Newsletter campaigns
- Book highlights for top subjects in China

Having limited scope without an official & authoritative digital presence as China is a digital-first economy



There is a need to create & sustain a structured cohesive approach to

- Identify the **right channels** & target **audience behavior**
- Build **brand awareness** & recall for Company Open
- **Engage & involve** audiences with strong messaging & new formats
- Foster **steady growth** from publications



2

Key Findings from Discovery Session

Background and Scope of the Project

Perceived obstacles identified

Competitive landscape analysis

Solution creation for Company Open

Key Findings from Discovery Session (1/2)



Core goal

- OA Books- 1500 full chapter submissions by end of 2025.
- Journals- Steady submissions from China

Core TG

Active Authors

Who want to publish with Intec Open or are in the process of publishing

Published Authors

Who have published with Intec Open

Readers

Larger academic community segmented by subjects who download and consume published content, subscribe to newsletters, and seek knowledge via books, journals, and independent papers.

All these 3 categories comprise primarily of senior professors, doctors, Ph.Ds in the field of Physical Sciences, Engineering, Technology & Health sciences

Key Findings from Discovery Sessions (2/2)

Past initiatives for China



Emailers

Targeted towards editors and authors with monthly newsletter & special occasion newsletter

Offline activities

Book fairs, road shows, University visits, offline communication to distributors etc.

Online

- Book highlight from top subjects
- Year wrap up Video explainers
- Social Media marketing and management

Value proposition of Company Open

Company Open is trusted by numerous established Nobel Laureates as well as many highly cited researchers in specific fields.

Intec Open provides dedicated support to Authors by services manager

Publishing process is clear and transparent

Authors published with Intec Open are provided auto-generated performance reports and most authors respond very well to looking at the citations and impact of their published research. These reports are used by authors to get grants and funds for their research



Background and Scope of the Project

Key Findings from Discovery Session

3

Perceived obstacles identified

Competitive landscape analysis

Solution creation for Company Open

Perceived Challenges

Strong Competitors

ELSEVIER SPRINGER NATURE Taylor & Francis AAAS
WILEY IOPscience

Company Open perception in China

- Significant dissatisfactory online discussions about Company Open
- Unclear value proposition for China

Email marketing

- Technology related limitations that affect performance
- Finding the right marketing automation technology for China





Background and Scope of the Project

Key Findings from Discovery Session

Perceived obstacles identified

4

Competitive landscape analysis

Solution creation for Company Open

Competitor Research

Players

SPRINGER NATURE

WILEY

IOPscience

ELSEVIER

Taylor & Francis
an informa business

AAAS

Platforms being leveraged

WeChat

新浪微博
weibo.com

Baidu 百度

搜狗搜索

bilibili

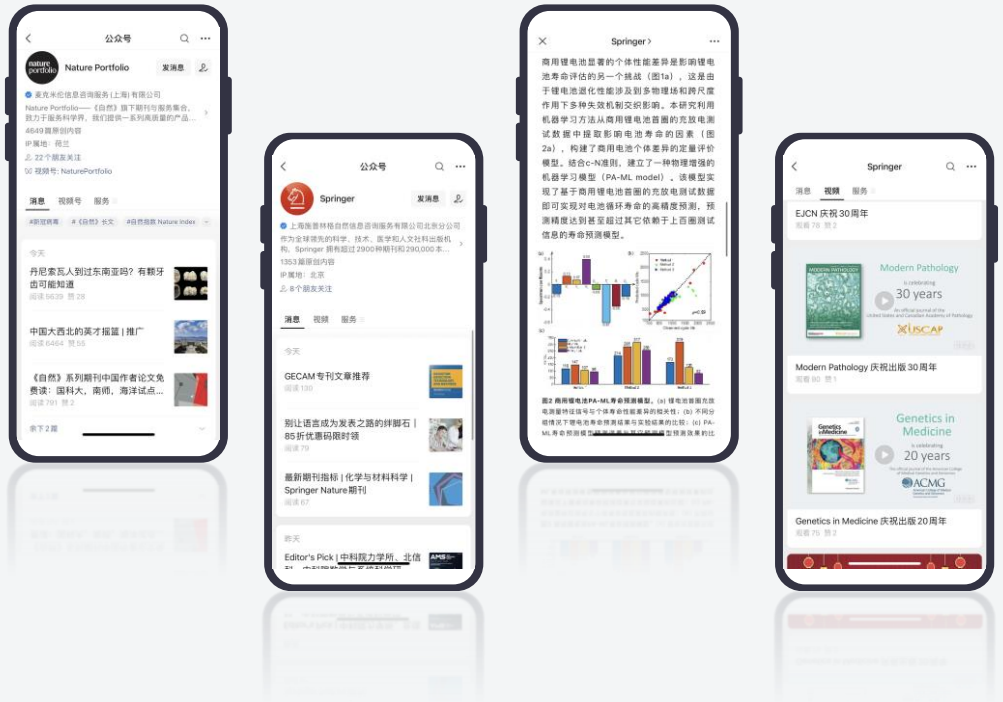
知乎

Players	Search Engine	WeChat	Weibo	Zhihu	Bilibili	Others
SpringerNature	Baidu Trust, Baidu Wiki, SEM, Sogou Wiki	Official Account, Video Channel, Mini Program	✓	✓	✓	Stream media
Wiley	Baidu Trust, Baidu Wiki, SEM, Sogou Wiki	Official Accounts, Video Channel	✓		✓	SCRM, Stream media
Elsevier	Baidu Trust, Baidu Wiki, SE0, Sogou Wiki	Official Accounts, Video Channel, Mini Program	✓	✓	✓	SCRM, Stream media
Taylor & Francis	Baidu Trust, Baidu Wiki, Sogou Wiki	Official Accounts, Video Channel, Mini Program	✓		✓	Stream media
IopScience	Baidu Wiki, Sogou Wiki	Official Accounts	✓			Stream media
AAAS	Baidu Wiki, Sogou Wiki	Official Accounts, Video Channel	✓			Stream media

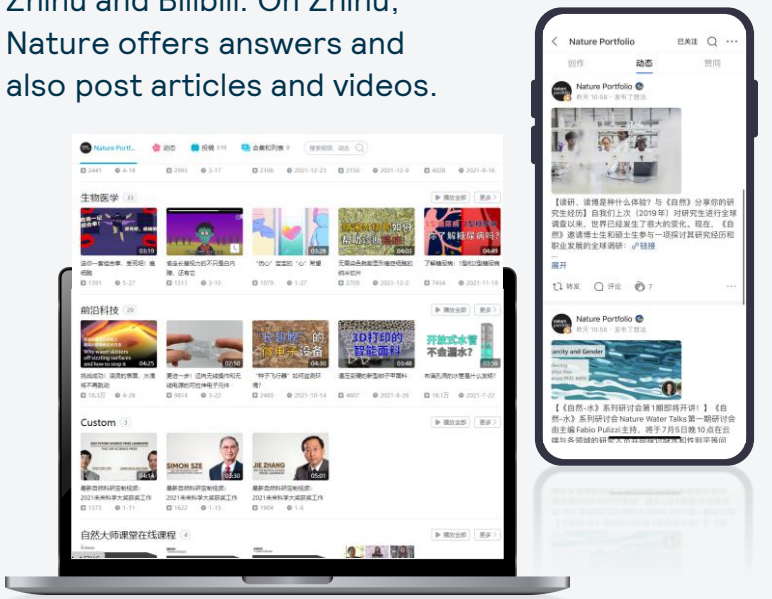
SPRINGER NATURE

Spinger Nature has 7 WeChat accounts for brand, specific field, researcher academy, nature portfolio etc. The content are cutting edge research, research trends, journal information, early career researcher empowerment. Compared to Springer, the content of Nature Portfolio on social is more popular science-oriented. Springer also leveraged SEM and other marketing tools on Baidu, the largest search engine.

WeChat Account and the post and videos within



Nature Portilio accounts on Zhihu and Bilibili. On Zhihu, Nature offers answers and also post articles and videos.



Springer's wiki and SEM on Baidu



WILEY

Wiley has 10 WeChat accounts for brand, editing service, Chem field, Environment field, Engineering field, OA, Cell filed, and Neuropsychology field and the brand account is to promote brand impact and product layout, while the subject accounts target on the research update, related journals info, and researcher community in the specific field.

To build the community for early career researchers and empower them, Wiley setup a h5 page with SCRM system inserted. The content on the H5 page is regarding publishing skills, webinars, editors' interviews and etc.



Wiley's content on Bilibili and Weibo for recently launched journal's promotion.



Taylor & Francis
an informa business

Taylor & Francis posts brand info, journals & books' info, editor & author's interview and webinars on its WeChat account. It also has librarian-oriented content on the platform too. T & F mini program offers the researchers a quick access to catch up with the submission process.
T&F also setup the Baidu trust for its 70+ journals to protect the traffic.

The WeChat official account, video channel and the posts.



Baidu Trust for T & F Journal or Book



Learnings from Competitors

Key observation

- High Focus on Early Career Researchers
- Various players are using multi-channel communication to reach different cohorts; especially ECRs.
  - ECR focus is vital because they
  - Support auxiliary research & facilitate submissions from professors
  - Are active users of social platforms & Company Open brand recall among ECRs will enhance social selling
  - Will nurture future submissions

Primary channels being leveraged by competitors

- WeChat
- Baidu

Secondary channels

- Bilibili
- Weibo
- Zhihu
- Press release

Content buckets to gain attention & respect

- Publisher value proposition
- Endorsements from authors & KOLs
- Research article spotlight
- Subject Area research series spotlight
- Researcher community building

Observation: Negative sentiment about Company Open

These dialogues are from Muchong, one of the biggest early & mid – career researchers' community





Observation: Negative sentiment about Company Open



Company Open is in discussions within researcher communities; these discussions are primarily about

- The authenticity of the brand
- High APC & corresponding ROI of publishing
- Ease of publishing

Most of these negative sentiments are due to **lack of official account** & authoritative presence of Company Open on primary social media channels



Background and Scope of the Project

Key Findings from Discovery Session

Perceived obstacles identified

Competitive landscape analysis

5

Solution creation for Company Open

Phase wise plan

Phase 1

Initiation

- Set up
  - Social media - WeChat ecosystem (Account, Wiki, video channel, KOL resources)
  - Searching engines - Baidu
- Reviewing global repository content to repurpose content for China
- Mitigate negative sentiment on Muchong
- Create a content calendar for WeChat

Phase 2

Expansion

- Expand to
  - Social media- Zhihu, Microblog
  - Search Engine- Sogou
  - Others- Sciencenet & Linkresearch
- Repurpose content into additional formats for specific channels

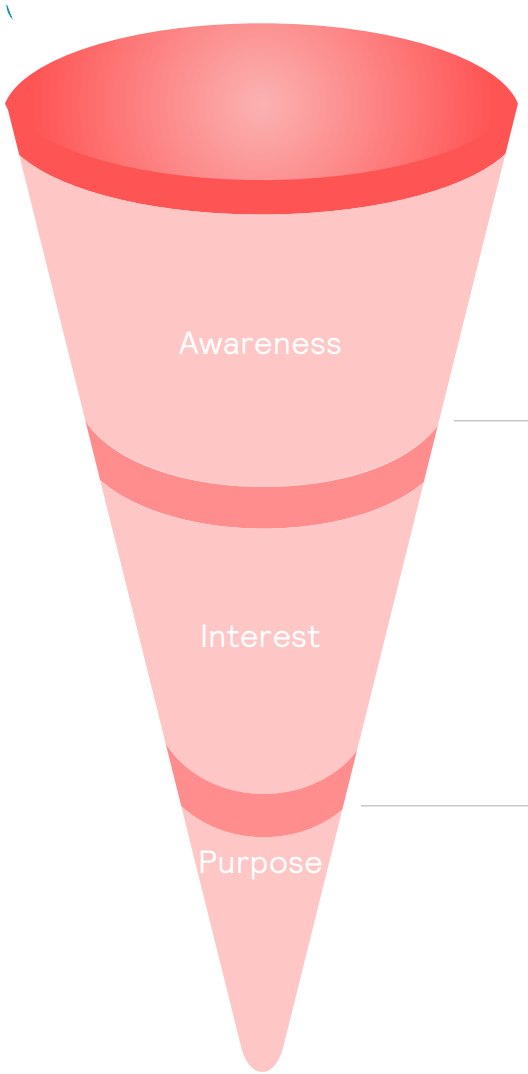
Phase 3

Segmented Outreach

- Reach new, untapped audience through:
  - More third-party platforms
  - Press releases to key media outlets
- Expand to- Mini program
- Foster shorter user journey by leveraging mini program functionality with an sCRM system

Phase 1: Initiation (0–6 months)

Phase 1 — Initiation
Phase 2 — Expansion
Phase 3 — Segmented Outreach



Content building

Awareness

1. **Review existing** Global content repository for China
2. **Creating** China content repository
3. Content for **OA philosophy** & belief

CTA
- Follow on WeChat
- Visit website

Interest

1. Producing **sales collateral for China Portfolio** under the head of “Open Science, Open Minds”
2. Producing **Journal launch & call-for-submissions** social media template
3. Producing **Impact Stories** segmented by subject areas.

CTA
- Visit website
- Contact us & learn more

Purpose

1. **Research spotlight of key authors**
2. **Author testimonials**

CTA
- Contact us & learn more
- Submit with us

Social (WeChat)

Awareness

1. **WeChat presence setup**
   - WeChat official account (service)
   - Video Channel
   - Sogou Wiki
2. **Muchong set-up**
3. **KOL**
   Creation of KOL list for Company Open
4. **Target Universities**
   Creation of Target University list to match relevant catalogue & subject areas

Interest

1. **WeChat Content Marketing**
   offering sales collateProvidingral, Journal launch & call for submissions & Impact stories to WeChat audiences
2. **Muchong Content Marketing**
   Addressing negative feedback
   - Bolstering global presence by sharing links to global social presence & link to WeChat account
   - Link to list of prolific Chinese authors who trust Company Open
3. **Events**
   - Announcing online/offline events for new authors
   - Panel Discussion among most prolific authors & editors

Purpose

1. **WeChat Content Marketing**
   - Increase in frequency of posts
   - AMA about publishing process fortnightly
   - Analysis of performance
2. **Testimonials**
   - Get Company Open’s authors talking

Search (Baidu)

Awareness

1. **Baidu ecosystem set up**
   - Baidu Wiki
   - Baidu Trust
   - Zhidao
2. **Localized webpage**
   A Chinese landing page

Interest

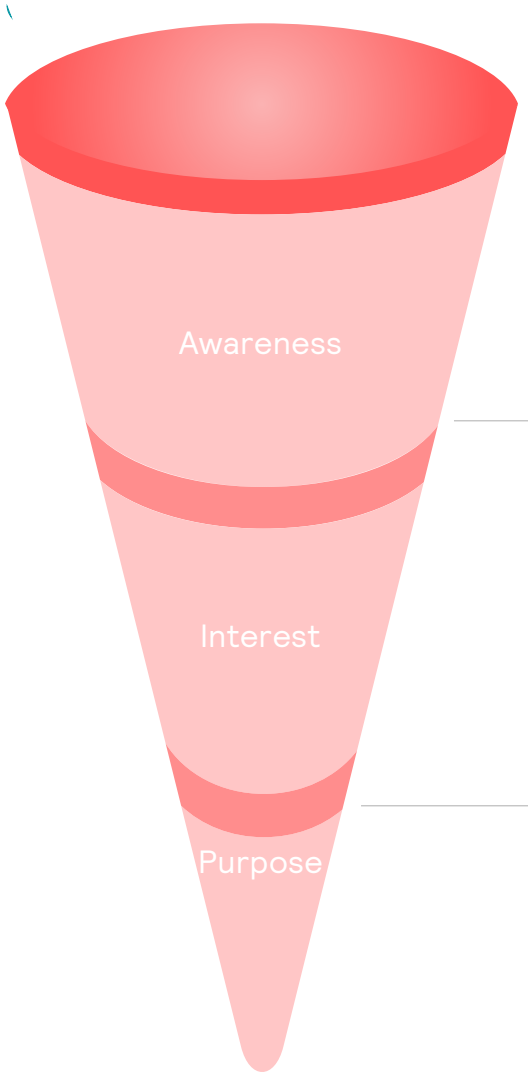
1. **Optimize landing page**
   SEO keywords
   - English
   - Chinese

Purpose

1. **Create SEM strategy**
   - Keywords
   - Competitors

Phase 2: Expansion (6–12 months)

Phase 1 — Initiation | **Phase 2 — Expansion** | Phase 3 — Segmented Outreach



Content building	Social (WeChat)	Social (WeChat)	Search (Baidu)
1. **Repurposing** Global & China content for **new channels** 2. **Content** production for **SEM** **CTA** ▪ Follow on social media ▪ Visit website	1. **Setup of presence:** ▪ Zhihu ▪ Microblog ▪ Bilibili 2. **Announcing launch:** ▪ Posts for WeChat & Email 3. **Blogs on OA** & author experience with Open Access	1. **Update of** ▪ Baidu Wiki ▪ Sogou Wiki 2. **SEM** Implementing a small budget SEM	1. **Setup presence** ▪ Sciencenet ▪ Linkresearcher ▪ Tencent account 2. **Press release** Company Open press release in China
Creating **original content** for **WeChat, Microblog & Zhihu in platform appropriate formats** **CTA** ▪ Read more about Company open ▪ Contact us for submissions	1. **Content Marketing** ▪ Research downloads milestones ▪ KOL engagement ▪ New publishing feature weekly 2. **Events** ▪ Book fair promotion ▪ Webinars for specific subject-matters ▪ Workshop on intro to OA	**Optimize SEM** The objective would change from awareness to engagement	**Collaboration** Explore & review collaboration with Science net & Link researcher for engagement
Creation of **author interviews** **CTA** Contact us for submissions	1. **Content Marketing** ▪ Increase in frequency of posts ▪ Analysis of performance 2. **Testimonials** ▪ Get Company Open's authors talking	**Optimize SEM Strategy** The objective to change from engagement to conversion	**Execute ad campaign** This would be planned in tandem with Baidu SEM

Phase 3: (12 month onwards)
Optimize & Grow

Phase 1 — Initiation
Phase 2 — Expansion
Phase 3 — Segmented Outreach



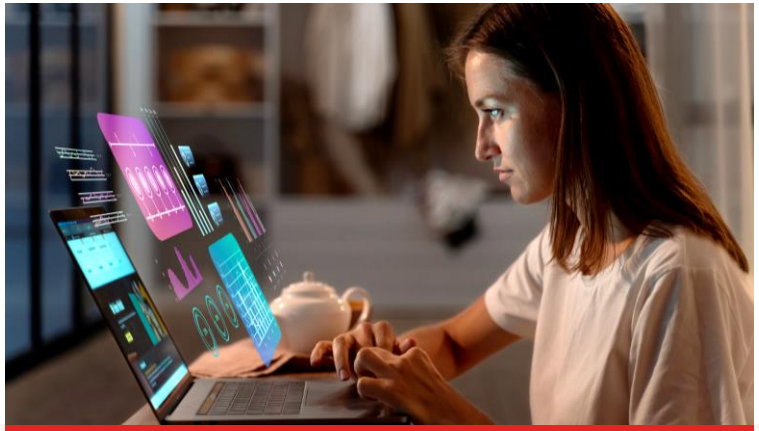
Cooperation with academic platforms to

- Reach new, focused audiences with specific scope & subject-area
- Keep Company Open top-of-mind within select platforms
- Enhance content on these platforms



A WeChat mini program to

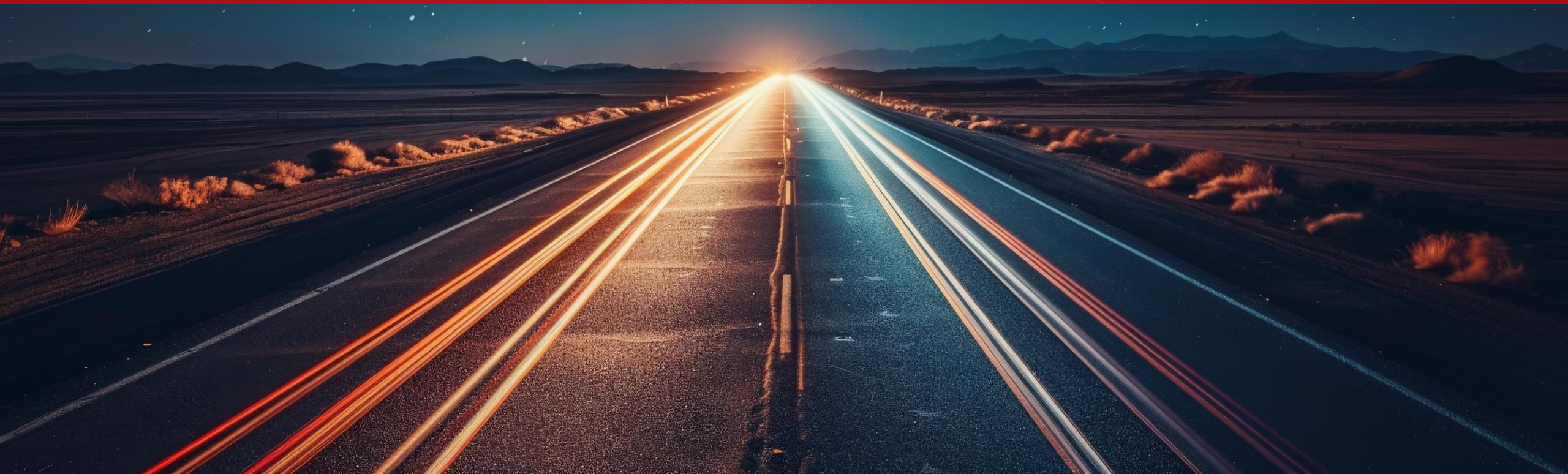
- Generate leads within WeChat
- Increase traffic to the landing page
- Impact engagement with content: Online Event, Online Curriculum
- Integrate with sCRM system to segment & track audience cohorts



An sCRM System to

- Gain & track users' insight
- Segment marketing strategy
- Track the users' lifetime journey
- Help improve the conversion rate

Way Forward




Thank you